



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 18

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Ladder Safety for Interior Finish Work

OVERVIEW:

Falls from ladders are the leading cause of fatalities in construction, and finish carpenters use ladders constantly — for crown molding, door hardware, ceiling trim, and upper cabinet installation. The familiarity of ladder use breeds complacency, and complacency causes falls. A fall from as low as

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Before you climb any ladder, inspect it. Check the feet for damage or missing non-slip pads. Check every rung for cracks, bends, or loose connections. Check the locking latches on an A-frame to make sure they are fully engaged on both sides. Check the spreader bar. A ladder that is not fully locked open is not safe to climb. If a ladder fails inspection, tag it out of service and remove it
2. The three points of contact rule is not just a slogan — it is the physical reality of what keeps you on the ladder. At all times while climbing, three of your four limbs must be in contact with the ladder — two hands and one foot, or two feet and one hand. This means you cannot climb while carrying materials in both hands. Use a tool belt, a bucket hook, or a rope to raise and lower
3. Overreaching is the most common cause of ladder falls on finish carpentry jobs. When reaching for the last few inches of crown molding or the top of a doorframe, operators lean out past the rails until the ladder tips. The rule is simple: if your belt buckle passes the side rail of the ladder, you are overreaching. Get down and move the ladder. The 30 seconds it takes to reposition is worth
4. For extension ladders, the 4-to-1 angle rule determines proper setup. For every 4 feet of vertical height, the base of the ladder should be 1 foot out from the wall. Too steep and the ladder can tip backward. Too shallow and it can slide out at the base. Secure the top of extension ladders to the structure whenever possible, and always have a second person foot the ladder during setup on

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Has anyone on this crew experienced a ladder fall or near-fall? What were the conditions?
Q2: Walk me through how you would properly set up a 24-foot extension ladder at this job site.

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Inspect ladders before every use — check feet, rungs, and latches
- Maintain 3 points of contact when climbing at all times
- Never stand on the top two rungs of any A-frame ladder
- Set extension ladders at 4:1 ratio (1 ft out for every 4 ft of height)
- Never carry tools that prevent use of both hands while on a ladder

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 18

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
01		click to sign	16		click to sign
02		click to sign	17		click to sign
03		click to sign	18		click to sign
04		click to sign	19		click to sign
05		click to sign	20		click to sign
06		click to sign	21		click to sign
07		click to sign	22		click to sign
08		click to sign	23		click to sign
09		click to sign	24		click to sign
10		click to sign	25		click to sign
11		click to sign	26		click to sign
12		click to sign	27		click to sign
13		click to sign	28		click to sign
14		click to sign	29		click to sign
15		click to sign	30		click to sign